

» AFTER

As American support for the war declined, the North Vietnamese politburo knew that it merely had to survive, not defeat US forces.

SEEING IT THROUGH

US forces would eventually **withdraw** from Vietnam, leaving the South Vietnamese Army (ARVN) alone to fight. The ARVN time and again **proved itself weak**, while the NVA only became stronger.

After US withdrawal in 1973, North Vietnam set its sights on defeating the ARVN and deposing the Saigon regime in order to reunify the country. **Vicious fighting** led to hundreds of thousands of deaths on both sides, before Vietnam was formally **reunified** as the Socialist Republic of Vietnam in 1975, a communist regime.